Session 2 — Student Activity Worksheet

Lecture 8 — Distinguishing between the Needs of the Self and the Needs of the Body

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Session Learning Outcomes

By the end of this session, you should be able to:

- Distinguish the need of the Self (continuous happiness) from the need of the Body (physical facility).
- Explain why the need of consciousness is fulfilled by the activity of consciousness, and the need of material by material.
- Identify the gross misunderstanding of treating the human being as only the Body, and its consequences (deprivation, exploitation).
- Relate the priority of needs to the reframing of “higher” and “basic” needs.

How to Engage with this Worksheet

- Whatever is stated here (and in the lecture) is a proposal — do not assume it to be true or false.
- Verify it on your own right, on the basis of your natural acceptance, and validate it in your living.
- Treat each question as a dialogue: first between you and the material, and then within your own Self — between what you are and what you really want to be.

Part A — Key Ideas (Recap)

- Need of the Self = continuous happiness = need of consciousness; fulfilled by right understanding and right feeling in the Self (activities of consciousness). It cannot be fulfilled by material.
- Need of the Body = physical facility (for nurturing, protection and right utilisation of the body) = material in nature; fulfilled by physio-chemical things (material). Material is definitely required, but the guidance of consciousness is also required.
- The two needs are of two different types and must be understood and fulfilled separately.
- Gross misunderstanding: assuming Human Being = Body, Respect = Physical Facility, Continuous = Unlimited — leading to unlimited accumulation of physical facility, and hence deprivation and exploitation.
- Need for clothes for protection of the body is required in a limited quantity, while need for clothes to get respect becomes undefined. Money is a man-made artefact used for exchange of physical facility, relating to the need of the Body.

- Right feeling is the feeling that is naturally acceptable to us. The need of the Self is of higher priority — taking care of it through right understanding and feeling makes fulfilling the need of the Body easier (a reframing of Maslow's hierarchy).

Part B — In-Class Activity

Activity 1 — Need of the Self or Need of the Body?

For each item, mark whether the deck treats it as a need of the Self or of the Body, and whether the quantity required is limited or undefined.

Item	Self / Body	Limited or Undefined
Food for nurturing the body	Body	Limited
Food for taste	Self	Undefined
Clothes for protection	Body	Limited
Clothes to get respect / be in fashion	Self	Undefined
Money	Body	Limited
Continuous happiness	Self	Undefined

Activity 2 — Spot the gross misunderstanding

Write the three equations that make up the gross misunderstanding, and the consequence the deck draws from it.

- Human Being = _____Body_____
- Respect = _____Physical Facility_____
- Continuous = _____Unlimited_____
- Consequence: _____Unlimited accumulation_____ and _____Deprivation _____

Part C — Long-Answer Questions

Answer in your own words, verifying each point on the basis of your natural acceptance.

Q1. Distinguish the need of the Self from the need of the Body in terms of what it is, in time (continuous/temporary), in quantity, and what fulfils it. **[5]**

The need of the Self is continuous happiness (consciousness), continuous in time, qualitative in nature, and fulfilled by right understanding and right feeling. The need of the Body is physical facility (material), temporary in time, limited in quantity, and fulfilled strictly by physio-chemical things.

Q2. “The need of consciousness cannot be fulfilled by material, and the need of material is fulfilled by material.” Explain with the examples of food/taste and respect. **[5]**

Consciousness needs (e.g., respect) require activities of consciousness (right understanding), whereas material needs (e.g., food for nurturing) require material inputs. Using food for bodily nourishment fulfills a physical need with a limited quantity, but seeking happiness solely through food taste tries to satisfy a need of the Self with a material input, which fails to provide continuous happiness.

Q3. What is the “gross misunderstanding” about the human being, and what does it lead to? **[5]**

The gross misunderstanding is assuming Human Being = Body, Respect = Physical Facility, and Continuous = Unlimited. This leads to an endless drive for unlimited accumulation of physical facilities, resulting in resource depletion, mutual exploitation, and feelings of deprivation.

Q4. The deck notes that most of our desires turn out to be needs of the Self, yet most of our effort goes into physical facility. Examine your own list of desires and state your conclusion. **[5]**

Analyzing personal desire lists typically reveals that most desires—such as status, approval, and affection—are qualitative needs of the Self. However, effort is predominantly spent accumulating physical facilities under the mistaken assumption that material things will satisfy these qualitative internal desires.

Self-Reflection (Take-Home)

- From your desire list, what fraction are needs of the Self versus needs of the Body? (FAQ, Slide 21)
- Trace one example of how money relates to the need of the Body. (FAQ, Slide 17)

Prepared strictly from the lecture/practice-session slides (L8). UHV-II, Module 2 — Harmony in the Human Being.